

My Explore Summary

Step 2 · Explore · Anna · 9 October 2026

One place, one honest picture, and your decision about what comes next.

The place I want to explore further

A rented house with land in the Serra do Açor, inland from Coimbra – around Góis, Arganil or Pampilhosa da Serra.

Country, region, nearest town

Portugal · Coimbra district · around Góis

Three reasons it fits my picture

It has the outside space and the daylight. The fibre is real, so my clients never notice. And it is a day from my sister: a flight to Porto and two hours on the road.

What it does not give me, and how I deal with that

It does not give me a market town on the doorstep. The nearest proper market is twenty-five minutes away, and I have decided I can live with that.

What a normal month costs there

About €2,360 a month, checked against real bills in February rather than brochure figures.

How my income will work there

€1,650 confirmed from the three clients. Everything above that is hoped for, not counted.

My legal route, and what I must prove

Residency as a self-employed person. I must prove steady income, health cover and an address.

Healthcare: how it works for me

Private cover for the first year, then the public system once I am registered.

What is still unknown

Whether the fibre holds in a storm. What the house really costs to heat in January. Whether I will still want this in my third winter.

Who I need: people, advisers, contacts

A Portuguese accountant, Rui and Ineke in the village, and my own lawyer for the paperwork.

What I choose now

Go further with this place

My next small step, within two weeks

Book a second visit in November, alone, for ten days

Date of this step

14 March 2027

When I will review what I learned

Mid-December 2027

This step takes patience. You now know more about the place than photographs can show, and you have a clearer list of what still needs checking.

A place does not become yours because it is beautiful.

It becomes yours because your life can work there.

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